

Prayers for our World and the Church

9th August 2026

Psalm 66:18-20

[18] If I regard wickedness in my heart, The Lord will not hear;

[19] But certainly God has heard; He has given heed to the voice of my prayer.

[20] Blessed be God, Who has not turned away my prayer Nor His lovingkindness from me.

Let us pray...

Thanks to God

O Lord, we thank You that You have heard us; we know the sin in our hearts but You have graciously forgiven and You listen when we call out to You.

We thank You for sending Jesus to save us. We thank You that He has freed us from the power of sin, and He has paid the penalty that was necessary to fulfill the requirements of Your holiness and righteousness. We thank You that You have overturned our old rebellious nature and given us New Life by the daily presence of the Holy Spirit within.

The Wide World... and the Wider Church

We pray for this world where so many still believe they can be good enough, or can save themselves by their own efforts. We pray that their eyes may be opened, that they will realise that there is an enemy blinding them to the Truth of your Word and that all their efforts are futile. We pray that our witness will be expressed humbly, knowing that we were once as they are, demonstrating that Your love and grace changed us, and seeking for them the same blessing of eternal life, according to Your ways, not ours.

We thank You for the many churches where Your Word is faithfully preached and lived, and for the fellowship of believers everywhere, so that we are encouraged towards love and good deeds. We know we are not alone in the struggles against sin and the pressures of this world. We give thanks for the good news of kingdom advances in many places, and we pray for the persecuted church, which suffers at the hands of terrorists and other enemies of the Truth. We also ask that You would strengthen Your people to stand firm but with grace, against the lies so popular today.

Ashburton

We pray for our work here at Ashburton, so that we too may be encouragers in fellowship one with another, and in support of the work of the Kingdom in other churches, other places. We pray for the Kurz family as they prepare to travel to Germany, and as they continue to prepare for the final move to PNG. We pray also for the work of Samaritan's Purse and Operation Christmas Child, so that families in remote parts of the globe may hear and respond to the Good News of Jesus through the delivery of shoeboxes. We pray that our expressions of love in small ways may be magnified through the work of the Holy Spirit when the children open and enjoy the contents of the boxes.

We give thanks for the work of the Selection Committee and continue to uphold the Exit Students Committee currently determining how to place the students into parishes. We pray for patience for ourselves as we acknowledge the difficulties of their task and the care and wisdom they apply to the decisions they need to make.

We continue in prayer for those in need of Your healing hand – for Russell, Joan, John, Levi and others affected by illness during this wintry season.

We thank You for Your Word, and for Leighton as he preaches today. We thank You for his preparation, and pray that You would encourage him as he brings it to us today. May he impart Your truth to us in a way that enables us to make it a part of our daily walk with You.

In Jesus Precious Name we pray, Amen.

Let us close by recalling the fundamentals of our faith by reciting The Apostle's Creed:

I believe in God, the Father almighty,
creator of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit
and born of the virgin Mary.
He suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died, and was buried;
he descended to hell.
The third day he rose again from the dead.
He ascended to heaven
and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty.
From there he will come to judge the living and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy catholic* church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and the life everlasting. Amen.